

Ubiquitous Immersiveness

In conversation with the folks over at Dolby to understand the company's journey in making their technologies increasingly prevalent

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Today, multimedia content is no longer being primarily consumed in movie theatres and on large home theatres but equally, or more so, on devices such as smartphones and tablets. Our smartphones and tablets are increasingly becoming capable content consumption machines, and Dolby has played a pivotal role in this. From Dolby Atmos to Dolby Vision to the new kid on the block – Dolby Music, all have made their way to numerous phones on the market today. Some of them priced at as low as ₹15K. To know more about Dolby's journey through the pandemic, how Dolby technologies have become increasingly pervasive, and more, we delved into conversation with Sameer Seth, Marketing Director India at Dolby Laboratories and Jayant Shah, Director Apps & Solutions Engineering, Emerging Markets at Dolby Laboratories.

Q Since the pandemic, people have been moving away from the theatres and consuming more content in their living rooms on TVs or on smartphones, on the go. What has Dolby observed in this regard? Any statistics to share? How has Dolby prepared for this shift?

Sameer: So the pandemic, in fact, has had a change in the way consumers consume content, especially in India. What we've seen in various consumer studies that we've done during the pandemic and post-pandemic is that Indian consumers, more than

ever before, have started realising the importance of quality audio and quality visual experience. They are increasingly seeking a better experience, whether it's in their living room, whether it's on the go. And now that they're back at work, even at work. So, talking about consumer studies, we found that what the consumers are definitely doing during the pandemic is connecting with content a lot more than they have connected in the past. So, when I spend more time with content, I'm insisting on a better experience. And for that, I'm now a consumer who's willing to upgrade. We did a recent consumer study Counterpoint on content consumption in the living room. We did one with CMR on the smartphone side. So, both those studies are actually pointing towards a two-pronged upgrade that the Indian consumer has done because he or she is connecting more with content. One, by upgrading the device for a better experience. So, you know, if I had an old TV, I'm upgrading to the latest television, and at the same time, I'm upgrading from a single device SD plan to a UHD Dolby Atmos or Dolby Vision-enabled plan on a streaming service. So, it's both devices and content and that's what we've seen the consumers doing off late.



Sameer Seth,
Marketing Director – India,
Dolby Laboratories

Q How many streaming services are supported by Dolby and is there a plan to have more streaming services in the Dolby ecosystem?

Sameer: I think it is no surprise that we Indians love the content. We connect with content far better than anything else. We work with a lot of streaming services, both global and Indian streaming services. So, you can get a Dolby experience on global services like Netflix, Apple TV Plus or Amazon Prime Video. As for Indian services, there are quite a few services that deliver

Dolby such as Disney+ Hotstar, Zee5 and Hoichoi. Hoichoi is our latest partner, who we worked with very recently, to enable their content with Dolby Atmos. So yes, there is a lot of momentum. There are some services on the AV side. Now, talking also about the audio side of the experience on streaming, we work with Earshot for podcasts. On the music side, we have Apple Music and Hun-

gama Music. So, both global and Indian services are now streaming their music in Dolby Atmos. So, the Indian consumer is spoiled for choice. There's a lot of content out there in Dolby.

Q Speaking of streaming music or even creating content, what about the content creators? Do they need specific equipment to create Dolby content?

Sameer: What the pandemic has also done is that now the consumer is also the creator. So from a creator's perspective, Dolby Atmos Music is a technology that the creator can use easily. The headphone mix can be done through a